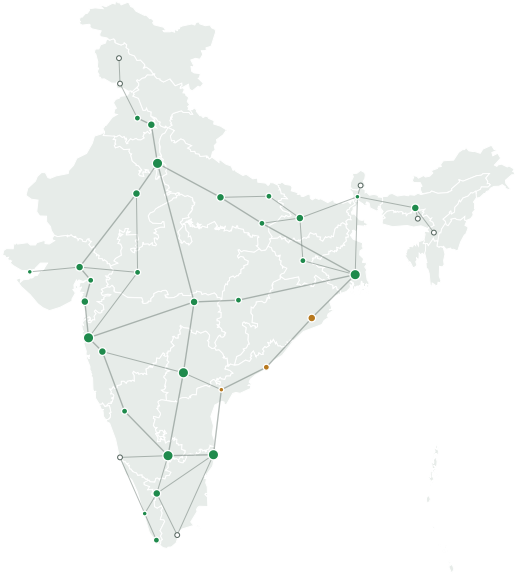
INB INDIA NETWORK BULLETIN · EDITION 022 WEDNESDAY 28 OCTOBER 2026 · 09:00 IST

91 trains cancelled as the storm crosses the Godavari coast

● NETWORK: AMBER

Cyclone Arnab crossed the coast near Yanam, beside Kakinada, in the early hours, with gusts up to 150 kmph[1,2]. At least 91 trains and 21 flights are cancelled across Tuesday and Wednesday[3], and the ports from Krishnapatnam to Visakhapatnam sit under storm warnings[4]. In the Gulf, Iran says a tanker hit mines near Hormuz and calls the Strait closed to ships it has not cleared[5].

THE LANES I'M WATCHING



Map: DataMeet, CC BY 4.0

- ● GREEN — freight running normally, which in a sale or festival week can still be busy
- ● AMBER — something is slowing freight, new or one that comes every year
- ● RED — something is stopping freight across a state or a route

Ennore Expressway, north Chennai ● AMBER

Closed on Tuesday as waves topped the sea wall; traffic sent via Ernavur bridge

Arnab's waves spilled over the embankment on Tuesday, knocked over dozens of vehicles and shut a stretch of the expressway, The New Indian Express reports[6]. Police have put traffic on a detour over Ernavur bridge. I'd expect trucks on the coast road to the north Chennai ports to lose an hour or two on each trip until the sea calms on Thursday.

Shimla–Bilaspur–Dharamshala highway ● AMBER

Back open to light vehicles since Tuesday evening; no word yet on trucks

NHAI shut the stretch near Khalota, in Bilaspur district, on Tuesday morning after the road subsided, and opened it again to light vehicles that evening, ThePrint reports from PTI[7]. It gives no date for trucks. I'd expect goods for Shimla and the upper districts to run several hours late on the narrower hill roads until at least the weekend.

Everywhere else runs as the season does, with no delay beyond it: the plains from Delhi to Punjab and Lucknow, Guwahati and Siliguri, Nagpur and Raipur. On the west coast, JNPA's rail queue for inland depots fell about 600 TEU in a day, to 2,910[8], so a box for Delhi or Gujarat moves within a day or two.

NETWORK INSIGHTS

1 Arnab stops trains on the Howrah–Chennai line, then takes its rain inland

The Howrah–Chennai line; Visakhapatnam, Gangavaram and Krishnapatnam ports; Vijayawada and the Godavari delta; east Uttar Pradesh and Jharkhand

AMBER · HIGH COST OF DELAY · HIGH CONFIDENCE

The storm moved faster than forecast and began crossing near Yanam after midnight, a few hours early, the IMD said[1]. Is it over once it crosses? Not for freight. The rain heads inland next, with IMD orange alerts for heavy rain around Varanasi and Prayagraj on Thursday and Friday, Hindustan Times reports[9], so I'd expect trucks there to slow. I'd expect the Howrah–Chennai line to run again from Thursday after track checks, and its backlog of loads to clear by Sunday. Loads held in Vijayawada for the delta towns move only by Saturday, I'd expect, once fallen trees are off the roads.

> **With coastal Andhra's trains off through today, I'd expect loads between the east and the south to wait into Thursday, or go the long way by Nagpur. Container ships at Visakhapatnam and Krishnapatnam lose two days of berthing, which I'd expect them to make up by Monday. Inland, I'd expect trucks and coal rakes across Jharkhand and east Uttar Pradesh to run slower until the rain passes on the 31st.**

2 Paradip ties down its cranes, and a second storm may follow Arnab

Paradip port; the roads of Odisha's southern hill districts

AMBER · MEDIUM COST OF DELAY · MEDIUM CONFIDENCE

Paradip, Odisha's biggest port, is on storm signal No. 2, so ships stand ready to leave for open sea and cranes are tied down[10]. It handled 335,000 tonnes on Monday, against 418,000 a year ago[11]. Is that the end of it? Well, maybe not. Some weather models show a second storm heading for Odisha within days, though experts call it uncertain, Down To Earth reports[12].

> **I'd expect two slow days at Paradip port and on the roads of Odisha's southern hill districts, today and Thursday. If that second storm forms, coal, ore and crude through Paradip are held a second time.**

3 Iran says Hormuz is closed again after a tanker hits mines

MEDIUM CONFIDENCE

Iran's navy says the tanker had switched off its tracking, and that any ship not cleared by its forces is unsafe to pass[13]. Where does India pay for it? At the import end, mostly. Its crude basket has averaged $120.46 a barrel this month, the highest monthly average since March 2012, as freight and marine insurance climb, BusinessLine reports[14]. Chennai Port has set space aside for transhipment boxes caught by the West Asia crisis[15], and handled 9,929 TEU on Sunday, its best day in five years[16].

> **Gulf cargo through Mundra, JNPA and Chennai stays slow and costly for weeks yet, and every crude tanker into the west coast refineries pays more for the voyage. Chennai, with room to spare, takes some of the transhipment that the Gulf can't.**

SOURCES

Built from public sources only. The ratings are my judgement on the likelihood of on-time delivery or cost-impact, not measured service levels or actual cost estimates. Confidence is High when the facts are dated and primary or measured, Medium when they rest on a proxy or a forecast. If I am wrong, we'll find out in the subsequent weeks.

1. The Statesman: Arnab begins landfall near Yanam, 28 Oct
2. Economic Times: Arnab's landfall continues, 28 Oct
3. India Today: flights and trains cancelled before landfall, 27 Oct
4. Kuehne+Nagel: Arnab and the east coast ports, 27 Oct
5. Anadolu: tanker hits mines east of Hormuz, 27 Oct
6. New Indian Express: waves flood Ennore Expressway, 27 Oct
7. ThePrint (PTI): Shimla–Dharamshala highway reopens to light vehicles, 27 Oct
8. JNPA daily status report, 27 Oct
9. Hindustan Times: Arnab's rain for east Uttar Pradesh, 27 Oct
10. Odisha TV: signal No. 2 at Paradip port, 27 Oct
11. Paradip Port daily traffic report, 26 Oct
12. Down To Earth: another Bay storm could head for Odisha, 27 Oct
13. Iran International: Iran's navy on the mined tanker, 27 Oct
14. BusinessLine: India's crude basket tops $120, 27 Oct
15. India Shipping News: Chennai Port's five-year high, 27 Oct
16. DT Next: Chennai Port's busiest day in five years, 27 Oct